

# INSTALL

## BobaLink — Installation Guide

**Revision:** 1 **Last modified:** 2026-06-10T21:00:00Z **Scope:** Building, loading, and running BobaLink (extension/) for end users and operators. **Authority:** extension/package.json, extension/wxt.config.ts, extension/ci-ext.sh, docs/browser\_extension/Status.md (Rev 4).

Accuracy note (§11.4.6): every command below is exactly as declared in extension/package.json / extension/ci-ext.sh. Steps not yet shipped are marked **(planned)**.

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## Requirements

- **Node.js**  $\geq 20$  (extension/package.json  $\rightarrow$  "engines": { "node": ">=20.0.0" }).
- **npm** (ships with Node).
- For the artifact gate: **jq** on PATH (the ci-ext.sh pre-flight requires node, npx, and jq).
- **A running Boba merge service on http://localhost:7187** to actually send torrents. BobaLink only talks to localhost:7187 (host\_permissions in wxt.config.ts). The extension *builds* and *loads* without it, but detect $\rightarrow$ send needs the backend up. Start it from the repo root with ./start.sh (see the project CLAUDE.md for the full Boba stack).
- Target browsers: Chrome  $\geq 109$  (minimum\_chrome\_version: "109") and Firefox (the build produces a firefox-mv2 artifact).

There is **no global install** of BobaLink — you build it from source and load it unpacked (the store-listing/submission path is **(planned)** — Phase 9).

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# Build

From the extension/ directory:

```
cd extension
npm install          # installs deps; postinstall runs `wxt
                    # prepare`
npx wxt build        # → .output/chrome-mv3/ (Chrome MV3, the
                    # default)
npx wxt build -b firefox # → .output/firefox-mv2/
```

Convenience npm scripts (declared in extension/package.json) wrap the same commands:

```
npm run build        # wxt build (Chrome)
npm run build:firefox # wxt build -b firefox (Firefox)
npm run zip          # wxt zip → .output/bobalink-1.0.0-
                    # chrome.zip
npm run zip:firefox  # wxt zip -b firefox → firefox + sources
                    # zips
```

npm run zip / npm run zip:firefox produce the per-store packages (bobalink-1.0.0-{chrome,firefox,sources}.zip) used for manual submission.

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## Load unpacked in Chrome (and Chromium / Edge / Opera / Yandex)

1. Run `npx wxt build` so `extension/.output/chrome-mv3/` exists.
2. Open `chrome://extensions`.
3. Toggle **Developer mode** on (top-right).
4. Click **Load unpacked**.
5. Select the **extension/.output/chrome-mv3** directory.

BobaLink appears in the toolbar. The build emits a valid MV3 manifest (manifest\_version: 3, background.service\_worker: background.js, popup.html, options.html, content-scripts/content.js, icons 16/32/48/128, and \_locales/{en,ru}/messages.json).

The `_locales/<default_locale>/messages.json` catalog is **required** because the manifest sets `default_locale: "en"` and uses `__MSG_*__` placeholders — Chrome rejects the extension at load if it is missing. The `ci-ext.sh` gate asserts it is present (§11.4.38; see Status.md Rev 4 for the bluff-audit that caught a build which had dropped it).

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# Load in Firefox

1. Run `npx wxt build -b firefox` so `extension/.output/firefox-mv2/` exists.
2. Open `about:debugging#/runtime/this-firefox`.
3. Click **Load Temporary Add-on....**
4. Select the `manifest.json` inside `extension/.output/firefox-mv2/`.

(Temporary add-ons are removed when Firefox restarts; reload after each rebuild.)

The Firefox build is MV2 (`firefox-mv2`) via WXT. Tab-group features are Chrome-only and degrade gracefully on Firefox.

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## The `ci-ext.sh` gate (manual release-readiness check)

`extension/ci-ext.sh` is the single, **manual** pre-release gate. Run it before packaging a release:

```
cd extension
bash ci-ext.sh
```

It runs, FAILing loudly at the first failing step:

1. **type gate** — `npx tsc --noEmit`
2. **lint gate** — `npm run lint`
3. **unit suite** — `npx vitest run` (exit-0 required; the count is **not** hardcoded)
4. **chrome build** — `npx wxt build`
5. **firefox build** — `npx wxt build -b firefox`
6. **§11.4.38 artifact verification** — opens the produced `.output/chrome-mv3/manifest.json` (not the source), asserts `manifest_version == 3`, the service worker is declared, and **every manifest-referenced asset plus the `_locales/<default_locale>/` catalog exists on disk and is non-zero** — including following each HTML page's local `src/href` references.
7. **per-store zips** — `npm run zip + npm run zip:firefox`, asserting each store zip is at least 10 KiB.

On success the final line is `CI-EXT: PASS`. The script touches **no git**, makes **no commit**, and starts **no container**.

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# NO CI/CD — manual only (permanent)

BobaLink has **no CI/CD pipeline of any kind** and none may be added:

- No `.github/workflows/`, no `.gitlab-ci.yml`, no Jenkins, no pipelines, no git hooks for this subproject (project CLAUDE.md “CI IS MANUAL”; plan §0.1; Boba Hard Stop §1).
- The reference materials shipped `ci.yml/release.yml` — those were **dropped**; their build/test/lint commands live only in the manual extension/`ci-ext.sh`.

All validation runs by hand via `bash ci-ext.sh` (and, at the repo level, the manual `./ci.sh`).

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## Verifying a working install

1. Build + load unpacked (above).
2. Start the Boba stack so the merge service answers on `http://localhost:7187`.
3. Visit a torrent page (e.g. one of the supported sites in `USER_GUIDE.md`).
4. Open the popup — detected magnets/.torrent links should be listed.
5. Click **Send** / **Send All**, or use a context-menu / keyboard action.

The end-to-end “torrent then appears in qBittorrent” confirmation against a live `:7187` backend is **(in progress)** (Phase 4 — see `Status.md`). The build/load and on-page detection steps are shipped.